



MINDFULNESS "HOW" SKILLS – NON-JUDGMENTALLY



TWO TYPES OF JUDGMENTS

1. Judgments That Discriminate

- To discriminate is to discern or analyze whether two things are the same or different, whether something meets some type of standard, or whether something fits the facts.
i.e. Teachers giving grades; a judge discriminates whether an action is against the law; an expert jeweler discriminates whether a given stone is really a diamond.

Discriminations are Necessary

- Discriminating between a swimming pool with water in it and one without water is essential before diving into it. Discriminating the effects of angry versus friendly behavior toward other people is essential to building lasting friendships.

2. Judgments That Evaluate

- To evaluate is to judge someone or something as GOOD or BAD, worthwhile or not, valuable or not.
- Evaluations are something we add to the facts. They are based on opinions, personal values and ideas in our minds. They are not part of factual reality.

Sometimes we use "good" and "bad" as shorthand when describing consequences

i.e. *When fish is slimy and old, and won't taste good if its eaten → "bad". If it is fresh and not contaminated → "good".*

When people hurt others, we call them "bad", when they help others, we call them "good".

When we use "good" and "bad" we forget that we are adding something to reality. We treat our judgments as facts.

"Good" and "bad" are never observed, they are evaluations in the mind of the observer.

Something "good" or worthwhile in the eyes of one person or group can be viewed as worthless or "bad" by another group or person.

i.e. *Tiger chases a man for dinner. What does the man think? What does the tiger think?*

GOALS OF BEING NONJUDGMENTAL:

1. Let go of Judgments that Evaluate as GOOD and BAD
2. Keep Judgments that Discriminate and See Consequences

BENEFITS OF NONJUDGMENTALNESS – WHY BE NONJUDGMENTAL?

- **Judgments Can Have Negative Effects on Relationships**

Negative judgmentalness creates conflict and damages relationships. Very few of us like people who are judgmental of us. Judging others may get them to change temporarily, but more often it leads people to avoid or retaliate against those who judge them badly.

- **Judgments Can Have Negative Effects on Emotions**

Adding judgments can have a huge impact on our emotions. When we label something or someone as “good” or “bad” it can have a strong effect on our emotional responses to people or things we are judging. It is often difficult to recognize that we created the judgments, and thus have created the very events that can dysregulate our emotions

- **Changing the Causes of Things Works Better than Judging**

Calling things “bad” or saying they “should not have happened” or “should be different” is ineffective and does not change things. i.e. In order to ensure pedestrian safety and decrease the number accidents on the road, there are laws in place that may result in fines or charges.

- **Nonjudgmentalness is Fundamental to Mindfulness**

Common concept to all mindfulness-based treatments and spiritual traditions of mindfulness.

**Just the
Facts**

NONJUDGMENTALLY – HOW TO DO IT?



- **Let go of “Good” and “Bad”**

View and describe reality as “what is”. Let go of evaluating people, their behaviour and events as good or bad. Stick to the facts when observing, describing and participating.

- **Replace Evaluations with Simple Statements of “IT IS” or with Descriptions of What Is**

The goal is not replacing “bad” with “good” or “worthless” with “worthwhile”. Eliminate evaluations entirely.

i.e. When buying a new house, rather than asking “Is it a good house?” we might ask “Is it a house I will like?” or “Is it a house that will last a long time without a lot of repairs?” or “Will I be able to sell it for more than I bought it for?”

- **Let go of “SHOULD”**

When being nonjudgmental we let go of saying and thinking that things should be different than they are and that we ourselves should be different than we are.

- **Replace “SHOULD” with Descriptions of Feelings or Desires**

“Things should be different!” → “I want things to be different”

“You should do this for me!” → “I hope you will do this for me”

“I should have been more assertive!” → “I want to be able to act more assertively”



REMEMBER



1. Nonjudgmentalness **DOES NOT MEAN APPROVAL**
2. Nonjudgmentalness **DOES NOT MEAN DENYING CONSEQUENCES**
 - A person who stops judging can still observe or predict consequences.
i.e. It is important to say "This piece of meat is filled with bacteria and may make you sick if you eat it" -- we are used to the shorthand way of saying this as "This piece of meat is bad." The facts may be that something is destructive or harmful, constructive or helpful.
3. Nonjudgmentalness **DOES NOT MEAN KEEPING QUIET ABOUT PREFERENCES OR DESIRES**
 - Asking for change is not judgmental. Avoid "SHOULD" statements.
 - Be careful not to turn preferences/wishes into commands. Reality does not work by our commands -- changing reality requires changing causes.
4. **DON'T JUDGE JUDGING!**
 - It is important to remember that you cannot change judging by judging judging.

Practice being Non-Judgmental

Reframe the following judgements non-judgmentally

1. *Judgement:* She is so selfish! She never bothers to offer help to us
Non-Judgement:
2. *Judgement:* I can't believe I said that I'm so weird
Non-Judgement:
3. *Judgement:* I am such a loser when I go to parties – People don't like to talk to me
Non-Judgement:
4. *Judgement:* I am so dumb – I should not have answered that.
Non-Judgement:
5. *Judgement:* My friend was late today – they should have known how annoying that is!
Non-Judgement:
6. *Judgement:* I can never get it right – that person has it all together!
Non-judgement:
7. *Judgement:* The barista at this coffee shop hates me because she didn't smile when I ordered
Non-judgement:
8. *Judgement:* My partner doesn't care – they never listen to me!
Non-judgement:
9. *Judgement:* They are such a good child, they always do their homework and get straight A's.
Non-judgement: